Movie costumes show two sisters sharing clothes

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A new movie of "Sense and Sensibility" is now in theaters. It is based on Jane Austen's first **novel**. It tells the story of two sisters. Elinor is **sensible**, and Marianne is **romantic**.

Costume designer Grace Snell made the clothes for the movie. The story takes place in England more than 200 years ago. Snell studied clothes from that time, but she also wanted them to feel modern.

Her big idea came from real life: sisters often borrow each other's clothes! After the family moves to a small cottage, the sisters share and mix their outfits.

At the **fittings**, Elinor's clothes were neat and organized. For Marianne, Snell brought boxes of ribbons and hats and let the actor dress herself. So Marianne has a playful style.

Snell gave both sisters jackets made from the same pattern and color, but in different **fabrics**. "They could wear the same outfit, but they were styled differently," Snell said.

Word Treasure

costume designer -- A costume designer plans and makes the clothes actors wear in a movie.

novel -- A novel is a long story written as a book.

sensible -- Sensible means careful and practical.

romantic -- Romantic here means full of big feelings and dreams.

fittings -- Fittings are times when actors try on clothes so they can be changed to fit.

fabrics -- Fabrics are cloth materials used to make clothes.

Background you need

Jane Austen was an English writer whose stories about families are still turned into movies today.

Movie costumes are planned carefully to show when a story happens and what each character is like.

"Sense and Sensibility" is about two sisters with very different personalities.

Break it down

WHO: Costume designer Grace Snell and the sisters Elinor and Marianne
WHAT: Costumes in the new "Sense and Sensibility" movie show the sisters sharing clothes
WHERE: A story set in England more than 200 years ago, now in movie theaters
WHY: Snell wanted the clothes to feel real and modern, like sisters borrowing outfits

Why it matters

It shows that the clothes in movies are chosen on purpose to tell us about the characters, just like the clothes you pick can show who you are.

Test what you remember

1. Who wrote the novel the movie is based on?

- (A) Elinor
- (B) Jane Austen
- (C) Grace Snell
- (D) Marianne

2. Which sister is sensible?

- (A) Both
- (B) Marianne
- (C) Neither
- (D) Elinor

3. Who made the clothes for the movie?

- (A) A clothing store
- (B) The sisters
- (C) Jane Austen
- (D) Costume designer Grace Snell

4. What real-life idea did Snell use?

- (A) Clothes should never match
- (B) Sisters often borrow each other's clothes
- (C) Only hats matter
- (D) Everyone wears the same uniform

5. What did Snell bring to Marianne's fitting?

- (A) Boxes of ribbons and hats
- (B) A sewing robot
- (C) Nothing
- (D) Only shoes

6. How were the sisters' jackets different?

- (A) They were different colors
- (B) They were in different fabrics
- (C) One was for winter
- (D) One had no buttons

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: D 3: D 4: B 5: A 6: B

Questions to think about

1. Grace Snell: Says the sisters could wear the same outfit but style it differently.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):